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# THE VENDETTA GAZETTE

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Print” • Two Cents (If You’re Still Alive to Pay)

★ TERRITORY GAINS THIS WEEK ★

|         |            |
|---------|------------|
| Wu-Tang | +164 turfs |
| Claude  | +163 turfs |

## THE WOLVES FEED AGAIN: WU-TANG AND THE MYSTERIOUS CLAUDE DIVIDE THE CITY BETWEEN THEM

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*Two Empires Gorge as Sir Caprice and Charle Reborn Are Picked to the Bone*

BY OUR MAN IN THE TRENCHES, IGNATIUS P. FLAMBEAU

Your correspondent has, over the long and frequently terrifying years of his employ at this distinguished organ, reported upon hurricanes, upon floods, upon the catastrophic implosion of no fewer than seven criminal dynasties. He has done so with professional detachment and only moderate consumption of bathtub gin. Yet this week, reader, he confesses to a certain *vertigo* — for what has transpired upon the map of Vendetta City is not a war so much as a **simultaneous devouring**, conducted by two vast and apparently insatiable predators operating in eerie, almost supernatural synchrony.

**Wu-Tang, the Iron Fist of the East Side**, whom your correspondent has chronicled with exhausted admiration these past several weeks, has once again seized one hundred and sixty-four turfs — stripping the already-skeletal **Sir Caprice** of what remained of that hapless gentleman's once-proud domain. But this week, Wu-Tang was not alone in his ravening. From the shadows of Vendetta City emerged a figure known only as **Claude**, who matched the Iron Fist stride for stride, block for block, with one hundred and sixty-three territorial conquests torn from the gutted holdings of **Charle Reborn**.

The symmetry, gentlemen, is enough to make a man's collar tighten of its own accord. Both conquerors launched precisely one hundred and sixty-four capture operations apiece. Wu-Tang plundered Sir Caprice's cashboxes and armories in eighty-two separate raids, hauling away **\$82,000 in combined cash and arms** between the two of them —

including one magnificent single haul in which Wu-Tang's boys descended upon the trembling Sir Caprice and departed with a cool **five hundred dollars cash and five hundred rounds of armament** in a single, beautiful evening's work. Claude, for his part, was no less industrious, conducting eighty-five raids upon the beleaguered Charle Reborn with the systematic thoroughness of a very well-organised bankruptcy proceeding.

One notes, with the grim fascination of a man watching two card sharps clear out the same table simultaneously, that the total occupied territory of Vendetta City did not shift by so much as a single tile this week. The city remains at twenty-two thousand, seven hundred and twenty-nine occupied turfs — meaning that what Wu-Tang and Claude gained, Sir Caprice and Charle Reborn lost in precise and pitiless measure. The map was not expanded. It was merely *redistributed*, as one redistributes the silverware after a funeral.

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#### TERRITORY GAINS THIS WEEK

|         |             |      |
|---------|-------------|------|
| Wu-Tang | <div></div> | +164 |
| Claude  | <div></div> | +163 |

## FLATTOP FORTIFIES: THE GARRISON THAT ATE THE NORTH QUARTER

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*Five Hundred and Fifty-Four New Recruits Reported; The Streets Grow Nervous*

BY OUR MAN IN THE TRENCHES, IGNATIUS P. FLAMBEAU

Away from the territorial carnage, a quieter but no less ominous development commands the attention of every self-respecting crime correspondent in this city. The individual known to the underworld as **Flattop** — so christened, one presumes, for the architectural qualities of his cranium — has this week added a staggering **five hundred and fifty-four gangsters** to his garrison, bringing his total military complement to a formidable **two thousand, one hundred and thirty-four souls**, all presumably of limited moral scruple and considerable personal menace.

Flattop has not, as yet, made any dramatic territorial moves. He has not raided. He has not conquered. He has simply *built*, with the patient, methodical energy of a man who is in absolutely no hurry because he knows something the rest of us do not. Whether this represents preparation for a campaign of conquest, a defensive fortification against anticipated aggression, or simply the hobby of a man with too much money and too many idle Enforcers, your correspondent cannot say with certainty — but he would advise the neighbours to water their plants and settle their affairs regardless.

Claude, meanwhile, added eleven units to his own garrison in between conquering half the map

